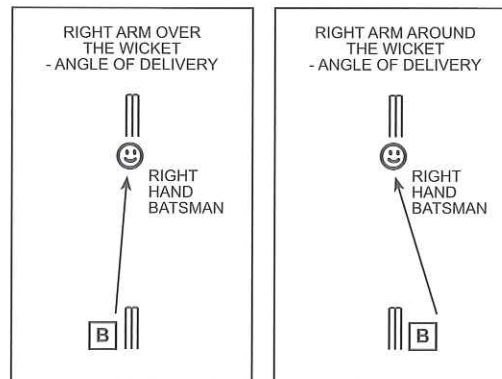


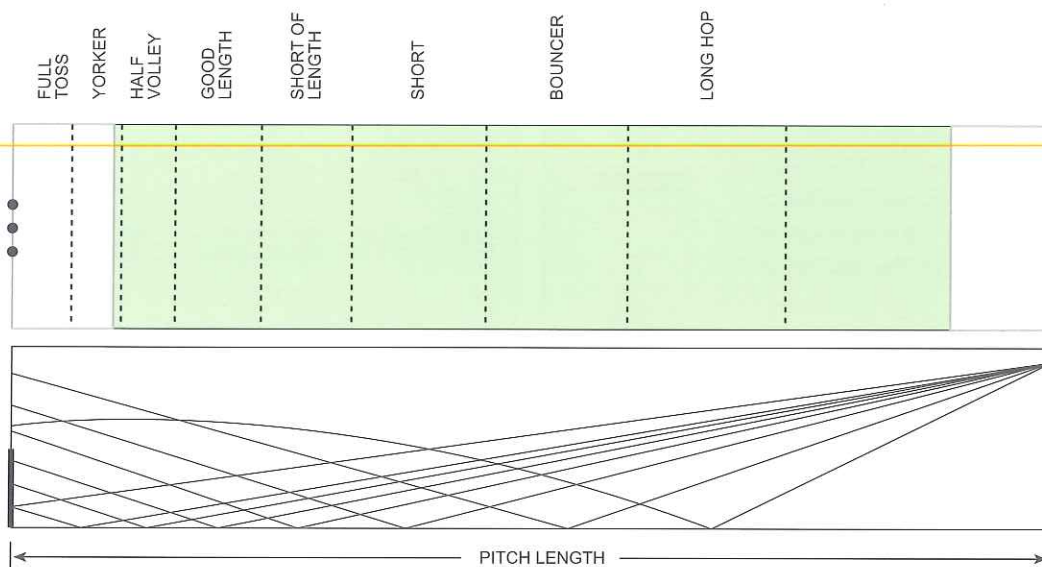


- To work hard at practice to improve their accuracy by learning to bowl a good line and length. Bowling a good line means to bowl at the stumps, in particular the middle and off stumps or just outside the offstump, while bowling a good length means to bowl the ball so it pitches about 2-3 metres in front of the batsman where he/she is unsure whether to play forward or back and is forced to play with a straight bat [see diagram 'Types and Lengths of Different Deliveries'].

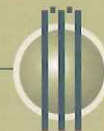
BOWLING 'OVER' AND 'AROUND' THE WICKET



TYPES and LENGTHS OF DIFFERENT DELIVERIES



It is also essential that you as a coach assist your young bowlers to improve their effectiveness and reduce their chances of potential injury by ensuring they develop technically sound and safe bowling actions. There are two recommended bowling actions that are considered 'safe' in that the back foot, hips and shoulders are in alignment and the spine is under the least amount of stress. These are the **'SIDE-ON'** action and the **'FRONT-ON'** action [see insets 'Bowling Actions' and 'A Note for Coaches'].



BOWLING ACTIONS

There are two main types of bowling action - **'SIDE-ON'** and **'FRONT-ON'**

The bowling action covered in this coaching manual is the **'SIDE-ON'** action. This means that the bowler in his/her run-up jumps or leaps into a side-on position to deliver the ball so that his/her:

- Back foot lands parallel to the crease.
- Front foot, shoulders and hips point down the wicket towards the batsman.
- Head looks over or through a raised front arm.



SIDE ON

Some young cricketers may have a **'FRONT-ON'** action and should not be discouraged. This means that the bowler in his/her run-up stays in a front-on position to deliver the ball so that his/her:

- Back foot on landing and front foot both point down the wicket towards the batsman.
- Shoulders and hips are parallel to the crease.
- Head looks inside a raised front arm.



FRONT ON

Both actions are equally acceptable as long as they are **'SAFE'** and therefore not **'MIXED'**.

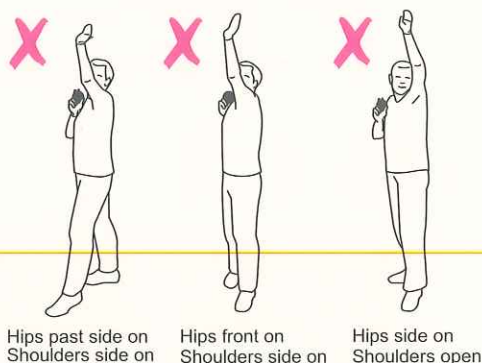
The basic adage is:

**"Keep the hips and shoulders in line and you'll be fine,
Twist the back, and it will crack."**

A NOTE FOR COACHES

As a coach you are well advised to check the bowling actions of your young bowlers to ensure they are safe. Actions are considered to be 'safe' when the back foot, hips and shoulders are in alignment when the ball is released. That is, the back foot, hips and shoulders are either all side-on or all front-on. Injuries occur, especially to backs, when bowlers have **MIXED** bowling actions. That is their actions combine aspects of both the side-on and front-on actions.

MIXED ACTIONS



Hips past side on
Shoulders side on

Hips front on
Shoulders side on

Hips side on
Shoulders open

As a coach check the action of each of your bowlers by observing the position of:

- The back foot on landing
- The hips
- The shoulders and front arm

They all should be in alignment for the action to be safe.

As a rule of thumb the position of the bowler's back foot will determine where the hips and shoulders should be. Take care in trying to correct a mixed bowling action. If you are unsure seek the advice, guidance and assistance of an experienced coach.



- 2 Thorough **PHYSICAL PREPARATION** or insisting each bowler trains regularly to develop and maintain his/her fitness. This increases their chance of improving performance and reduces their risk of injury. One of the best ways for young bowlers to stay fit is to keep active throughout the year. Playing sport during the winter will assist in this respect. Regular running, stretching, and effective warm-ups during the cricket season are also necessary to ensure bowlers are fully prepared and ready to go when they are required to bowl at practices and in matches.

In addition to physical preparation you also need to be aware as a coach of each bowler's workload. This is best done by monitoring the number of overs each of your bowlers, especially the pace bowlers, bowls at practices and in matches. This is not only to safeguard their physical wellbeing, but also to ensure the bowling load is shared more evenly between the bowlers. Indeed, to prevent overuse, junior and youth grades have guidelines which recommend the number of overs a bowler can bowl in a spell, a day and/or a match. Make sure you know the guidelines applicable to the age group and/or grade in which your team competes.

- 3 Good **CONCENTRATION** or getting each bowler to run in focusing on how [i.e. in terms of a game plan] and where [i.e. in terms of line and length] he/she intends to bowl each ball. The former depends upon the different skills and abilities of each bowler and his/her game plan for each batsman as to what type of delivery he/she decides to bowl as he/she



walks back to his/her mark. The latter requires each bowler to bowl one side of the wicket to the field set by establishing a target line or channel to bowl [e.g. off stump or just outside] with a specific target spot to fix his/her eyes on as he/she runs into bowl [e.g. for most pace bowlers this is the base of offstump, while for spin bowlers it tends to be an area on the pitch where they want to land the ball]. In this way bowlers are able to exert pressure on batsmen through consistency, control and working to a game plan.

- 4 A simple **GAME PLAN** or encouraging each bowler to think about their bowling, know what he/she can do and adopt a positive bowling plan or approach. Bowlers should be made aware that bowling is much more than just running in and letting the ball go. While young bowlers should be encouraged to bowl fast or to spin the bowl hard, they should also be encouraged to identify their main or stock delivery and to work hard on learning how to bowl it consistently so that it hits the top of off stump.



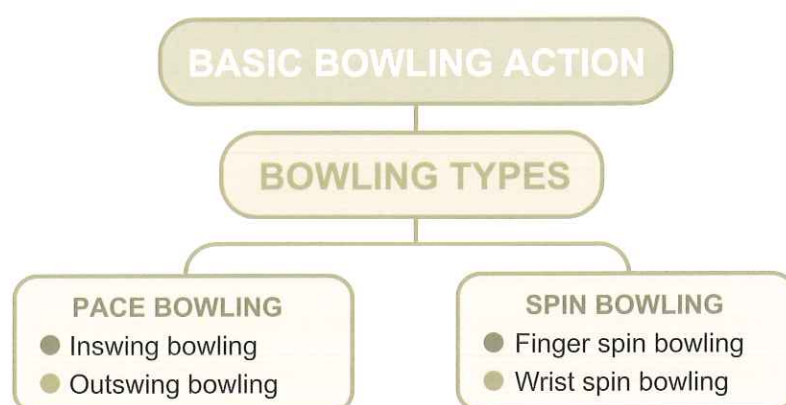
For example, pace bowlers should adjust their length and swing to hit off stump, off spinners should pitch the ball outside off to try and hit off stump, and leg spin bowlers should pitch the ball on middle to spin and hit off stump. If they err it should be in the channel just outside the off stump rather than down the leg side.

Initially the improvement in accuracy will often increase a young bowler's effectiveness. However, as bowlers progress further they will need to start thinking more about each batsman's strengths and weaknesses, the wind direction, the condition of the pitch, the state of the game, and where to place the field, and to use this information to develop a specific plan as to how they intend to dismiss each batsman. Their greater control of line and length will enable them to incorporate a wider range of tactical options [e.g. variations in line, length, pace, swing, seam, spin, flight, and/or the use of the crease] to attack or contain batsmen into their bowling plan [see 'Bowling Tactics'].



To develop their tactical awareness bowlers should try to assess their own players at practice, especially in a net session. They should study their grips, their stances, their favourite strokes and the deliveries that cause them most difficulty and try and devise a plan as to how and where they should bowl to different batsmen. For example, bowling slightly shorter to batsmen driving well, and bowling fuller or a closer line to batsmen hooking or cutting. Once bowlers have learned to assess their own players, they will find it easier to judge and outwit new batsmen in a game situation.

This section on bowling covers the skills and drills necessary to develop an effective bowling action and to execute two types of both pace and spin bowling.





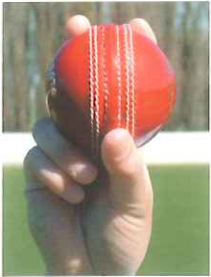
SKILL - Bowling - The Basic Grip

THE BASIC GRIP



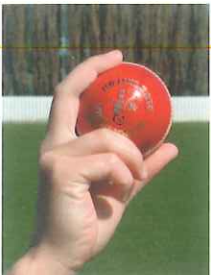
1

- Hold the ball with the seam vertical.
- First two fingers on either side of the seam on top of the ball.



2

- Supported by the thumb on the seam underneath the ball.



3

- Keep the grip light and relaxed with the ball in the fingers not in the palm of the hand.



SKILL - The Basic Bowling Action - Developing the Action

DEVELOPING A BOWLING ACTION



1

- Stand side on.
- Feet shoulder width apart.
- Back foot parallel to the stumps.
- Front foot turned towards the batsman.
- Head still, eyes level and turned to look at the batsman.
- Hands together with the ball in close to the chest under the chin.



2

- Stretch the hands apart.
- Reach high with the front arm.
- Look over the front shoulder or from behind the front arm.
- Push the bowling arm down to the back hip.



3

- Rotate both the arms.
- Pull the elbow of the front arm down to the front hip.
- Swing the bowling arm over straight brushing the ear.
- Release the ball.



4

- Swing the arms through.
- Front arm moves down past the front hip.
- Followed by the bowling arm across the body to the front hip.
- Keep the head still, eyes level and focused on the batsman.



1. Stand side on.

2. Stretch the string

3. Pull the string

4. Put your hand in the back pocket, i.e. follow through



● DRILLS: The Basic Bowling Action - The Grip and Developing The Action

DRILL DESCRIPTION

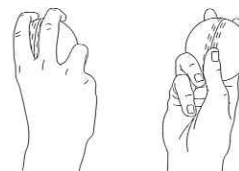
1 THE GRIP

EQUIPMENT: 1 cricket ball per pair.

DRILL:

- Player A to pick up and grip the ball correctly.
- Player B to check to see the following are correct - **the first two fingers are on either side of the top of the seam, the thumb is on the seam underneath the ball, and the ball is held in the fingers not in the palm of the hand.**
- Players then to change over and repeat the check.

DRILL LAYOUT

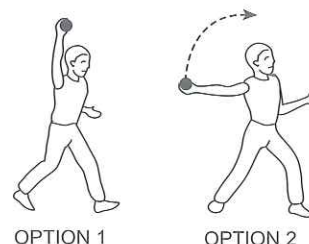


2 DEVELOPING THE ACTION 1

EQUIPMENT: 2 cones, 1 cricket ball per pair.

DRILL:

- Set up two cones 10 metres apart with one player behind each cone.
- Option 1: Player A to stand side-on facing player B with the feet comfortably apart, the front elbow tucked into the front hip, and the bowling arm gripping the ball correctly raised vertically above the head. Player A to bowl the ball by swinging the bowling arm down and across the body giving the ball a flick with the wrist as it is released.
- Option 2: Player A to stand side-on as above, but to lower the bowling arm back to the horizontal and to bowl to player B by swinging the bowling arm over straight, brushing the ear, before bringing it down and across the body giving the ball a flick with the wrist as it is released.
- Player B to stop the ball, then to adopt the above side-on position and bowl the ball back to player A.
- Each player to bowl 12 deliveries [2 overs].

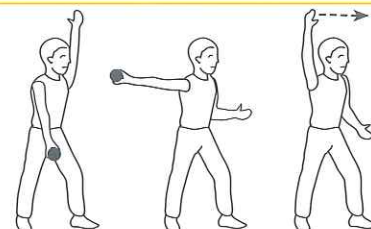


3 DEVELOPING THE ACTION 2

EQUIPMENT: 2 cones, 1 cricket ball per pair.

DRILLS:

- Set up two cones 10 metres apart with one player behind each cone.
- Player A to stand side-on facing player B with the feet comfortably apart, looking over the front shoulder, the front arm up high, the bowling arm gripping the ball correctly down by the back leg.
- Player A to rotate the arms by pulling the elbow of the front arm down into the front hip and swinging the bowling arm over straight to release the ball next to the ear before bringing it down across the body to finish alongside the hip of the front leg.
- Player B to stop the ball, then to adopt the above side-on position and bowl the ball back to player A.
- Each player to bowl 12 deliveries [2 overs].
- **Variation:**
 - Player A to stand in the above side-on position and to rock forward on to the front foot, then back on to the back foot, before rocking forward again and at the same time rotating the arms to release the ball.

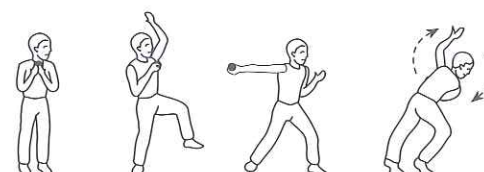


4 DEVELOPING THE ACTION 3

EQUIPMENT: 2 cones, 1 cricket ball per pair.

DRILLS:

- Set up two cones 10 metres apart with one player behind each cone.
- Option 1: Player A to stand side-on facing player B with the feet comfortably apart, looking over the front shoulder, with the hands together against the chest, the bowling hand gripping the ball correctly.
 - Player A to bowl to player B by unfurling the arms initially pushing the front arm up high above the head and bringing the bowling hand down beside the back leg before rotating the arms as in drill 3.
- Option 2: Player A to stand in the side-on position as in option 1 except with the feet together.
 - Player A to lift the front knee up close to the body and then to step forward and bowl to player B as in option 1.
- Player B to stop the ball, then to adopt the above side-on position and bowl the ball back to player A.
- Each player to bowl 12 deliveries [2 overs].





SKILL - The Basic Bowling Action - Walk Up and Bowl

1

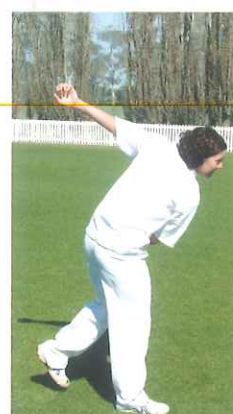
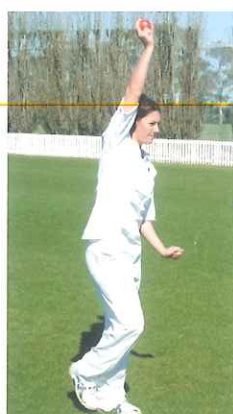
- Stand three paces behind the stumps facing the batsman.

3

- Unfurl the arms.
- Reach high with the front arm.
- Lean the body backwards.
- Look over the front shoulder or from behind the front arm with the eyes fixed on the target.
- Bring the bowling arm down from under the chin to the back hip.

5

- Swing the arms through.
- Front arm down past the front hip.
- Followed by the bowling arm across the body to the front hip.
- Step through with the back leg so the bowling arm shoulder is pointed towards the batsman.
- Keep the head still, eyes level and focused on the batsman.



2

- Walk forward stepping right, left and right again turning the body through 90° to land side-on before swinging the left leg across the body to point towards the batsman.

4

- Rotate the arms.
- Pull the elbow of the front arm down to the front hip in the direction of the target.
- Swing the bowling arm over straight, brushing the ear.
- Release the ball.

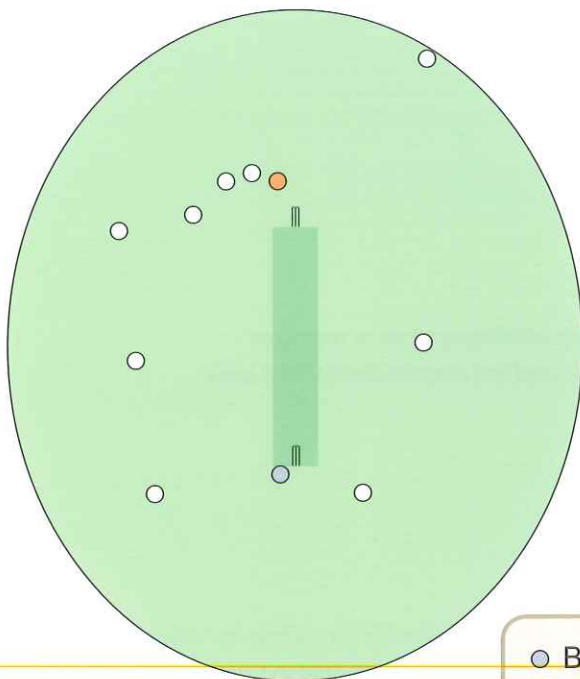
Left arm bowlers begin by stepping onto the left foot first in the walk up and bowl sequence.



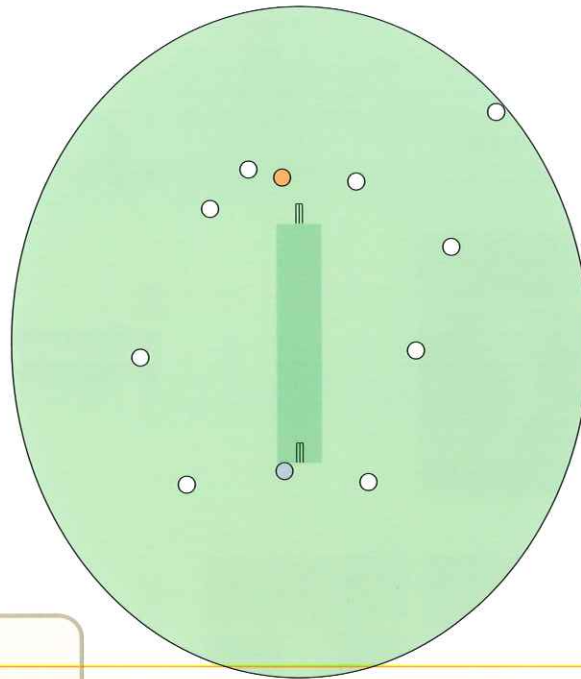
FIELDING POSITIONS FOR DIFFERENT BOWLERS

NB: The fielding positions illustrated are intended as guidelines only and are attacking fields for right handed batsmen.

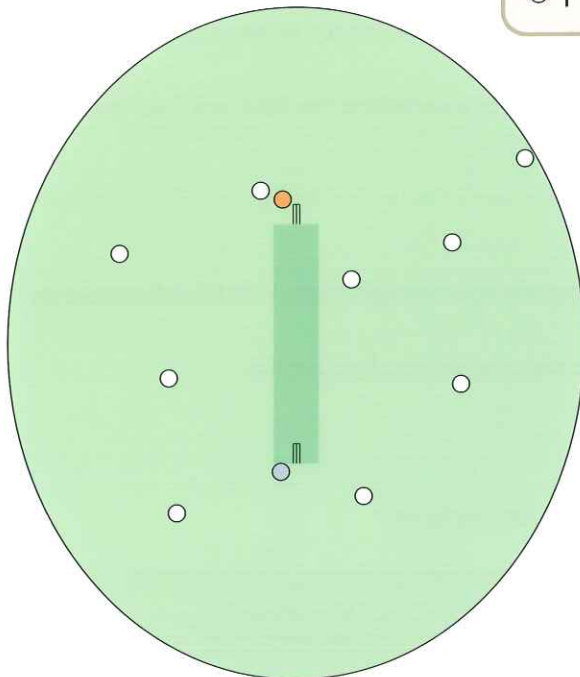
OUT SWING BOWLER



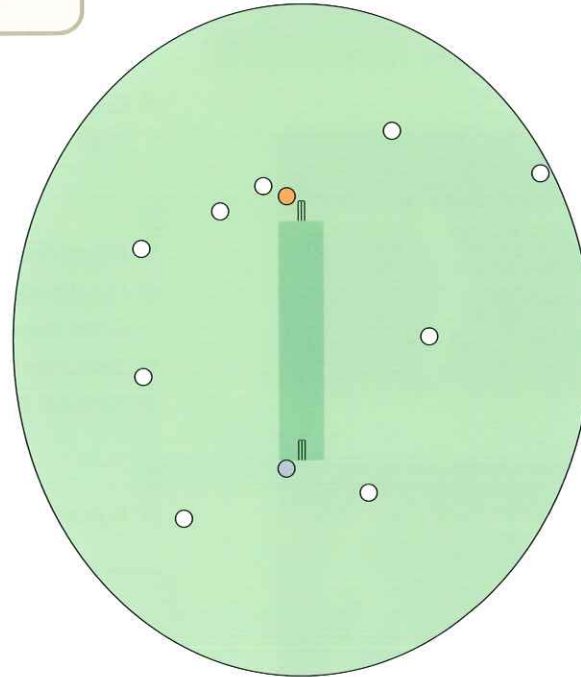
IN SWING BOWLER



OFF SPIN BOWLER



LEG SPIN BOWLER

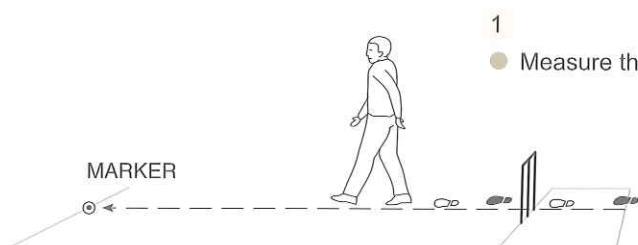


- Bowler
- Wicketkeeper
- Fielders

Encourage bowlers to think about the fielding positions they require for their type of bowling and get them to draw up attacking and defensive fielding plans to show the positions they require for both right and left handed batsmen [see Appendix 4: 'Bowler's Fielding Positions'].



SKILL - The Basic Bowling Action - Run Up and Bowl



1

- Measure the run up.



2

- Run in straight gradually building up rhythm and pace.
- Head steady, eyes level and the arms in close to the body.



3

- On reaching the stumps jump into the delivery stride by taking off on the foot opposite the bowling arm and turning so that the back foot lands side-on and is in alignment with the hips and shoulders.
- Unfurl the arms - reach high with the front arm, lean the body backwards, and bring the bowling arm up under the chin before being pushed down to the back hip.
- Look over the front shoulder or from behind the front arm, with the eyes fixed on the target.



4

- Rotate the arms.
- Pull the elbow of the front arm down strongly to the front hip in the direction of the target.
- Swing the bowling arm over straight, brushing the ear.
- Release the ball.



5

- Follow through as in 'Walk Up and Bowl'.

MEASURING A BOWLER'S RUN UP

Start from a fixed mark and run away from this gradually building up momentum until it feels 'right' to jump and bowl. Mark where the front foot lands in the delivery stride. Repeat this several times until a consistent mark is found. Pace out the distance between the two marks counting the number of regular walking steps. This is the length of the run up.

In a match stand with the heels on the batting crease then walk back past the stumps to pace out the run up and mark its length.



DRILLS: The Bowling Action

DRILL DESCRIPTION

1 DEVELOPING THE ACTION - WALK UP and BOWL

EQUIPMENT: 2 cones, 1 cricket ball per pair.

DRILL:

- Set up two cones 15 metres apart with one player behind each cone.
- Player A to walk back three paces, turn and face player B, and then using the walk up and bowl sequence to bowl the ball to player B.
- Player B to stop the ball, and using the same sequence bowl the ball back to the player A.
- Each player to bowl 12 deliveries [2 overs].

2 DEVELOPING THE ACTION - THE JUMP or TAKE-OFF

EQUIPMENT: 4 cones per pair.

DRILL:

- Set up two cones 5 metres apart with both players lined up behind one cone.
- Each player to raise his/her bowling arm and stamp the opposite foot which in the run up is the 'take off' foot.
- Each player then to stand with his/her feet together. Starting with the right foot for right arm bowlers [left foot for left arm bowlers] jog towards the second cone and jump over it by 'taking off' on the correct foot and landing on the other. Throw the arms in the air to gain more height.
- Repeat several times, then get each player to 'take off' on the correct foot, turn through 90° in mid-air and land side-on on the other foot. [NB: Right arm bowlers turn to the right, left arm bowlers to the left to get side-on].
- Repeat until all players are able to 'take off' and land 'side-on' correctly.

3 DEVELOPING THE ACTION - RUN UP and BOWL

EQUIPMENT: 2 sets of stumps, 1 cricket ball per pair.

DRILLS:

- Set up the two sets of stumps 15-20 metres apart with one player behind each set.
- **THE RUN UP:** Player A to measure his/her run up, then to run in straight gradually building up momentum before taking off and turning to land in a side-on position.
- **THE DELIVERY:** Player A to unfurl and rotate the arms to bowl the ball.
- **THE FOLLOW THROUGH:** Player A to continue forward with the back leg stepping through and across the body to finish with the bowling arm shoulder pointing towards player B.
- Player B to stop the ball and repeat the drill by bowling the ball back to player A.
- Each player to bowl 12 deliveries [2 overs].
- **Variation:**
 - Players to take turns to run in and bowl with the eyes closed to 'feel' the natural rhythm of the bowling action. Partner to comment on the accuracy of each delivery.

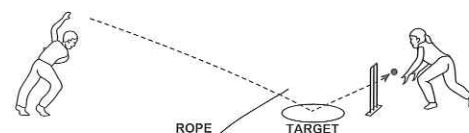
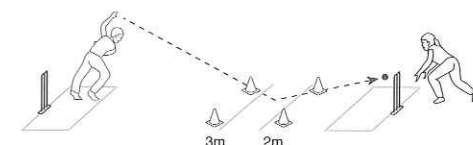
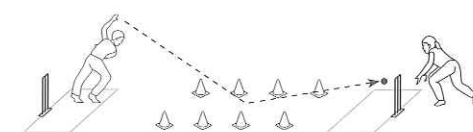
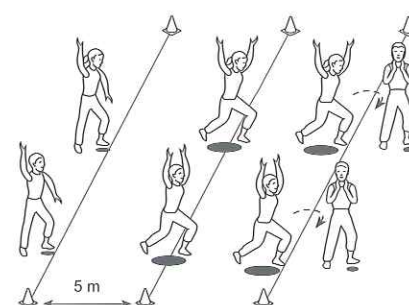
4 DEVELOPING THE ACTION - BOWLING FOR DIRECTION [LINE] and DISTANCE [LENGTH]

EQUIPMENT: 8 cones or 2 x 4 metre lengths of rope, 2 sets of stumps, 1 cricket ball per pair.

DRILLS:

- Set up the two sets of stumps 20 metres apart with one player behind each set.
- **Option 1 - Line:** Set up pairs of cones or the two lengths of rope along the pitch to create a channel 50cm wide from middle stump to outside offstump.
- **Option 2 - Length:** Set up two pairs of cones or place the two lengths of rope across the pitch 2 and 3 metres from the batting crease to create a 'good length' zone.
- Player A to measure his/her run-up, then to run in and try to bowl the ball down the channel in option 1, or to land it in the zone in option 2.
- Player B to stop the ball, and return it to player A.
- Each player to bowl 6 deliveries [1 over], then to change over. After completing 2-4 overs each, the player landing the most deliveries in the channel in option 1, or in the zone in option 2, is the winner.
- **Variations:**
 - For line drills adjust the width of the channel to match the skill of the bowler and/or the position of the channel e.g. for a left hand batsman.
 - For length drills adjust the width of the ropes to match the skill of the bowler, and/or the position of the zone e.g. for yorkers, short of a length deliveries.
 - To combine line and length drills replace the zone with a specific target e.g. a 50cm x 100cm rectangle of cardboard, carpet or plywood placed on the pitch 4 metres in front of the stumps and include a scoring system for hitting the target and the stumps.
 - The target can be reduced in size for more experienced bowlers and/or it can be moved to suit the line and length for spin bowlers and/or for bowling to right or left hand batsmen.

DRILL LAYOUT





SKILL - Pace Bowling - Outswing and Inswing Bowling

Pace bowling is about taking wickets through the control of pace, line and length and swing and/or seam. Most teams have several fast and/or medium pace bowlers. It is usual for the team's fast bowlers to open the bowling and spearhead the bowling attack.

Pace bowlers who learn to swing the ball in the air into or away from batsmen add to their ability to deceive and dismiss batsmen. To swing the ball bowlers need to shine one side of it and to grip and release it correctly. Generally the ball will swing, provided the seam remains upright, in the direction the seam is angled, with the shiny side of the ball on the outside of the intended curve. To achieve maximum swing bowlers must keep the ball pitched up to the batsman and direct their attack on the offstump or just outside.

OUTSWING BOWLING

Right arm outswing bowlers swing the ball **AWAY** from right hand batsmen towards the slips the intention is to bowl or dismiss them with catches behind the wicket.

OUTSWING GRIP



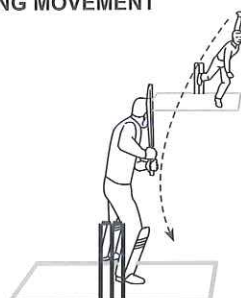
- Seam vertical but angled towards first slip.
- Shiny side of the ball faces the leg side.
- First two fingers close together on the seam.
- Side of the thumb underneath the ball on the seam.

OUTSWING DELIVERY



- Bowled from close to the stumps.
- Ball released with the bowling arm high, the hand and fingers behind the ball.
- Head still, eyes level and focused on the target.
- Follow through strongly with the bowling arm across the body.

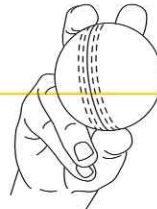
OUTSWING MOVEMENT



INSWING BOWLING

Right arm inswing bowlers swing the ball **INTO** right hand batsmen from the offside in an attempt to dismiss them bowled or LBW.

INSWING GRIP



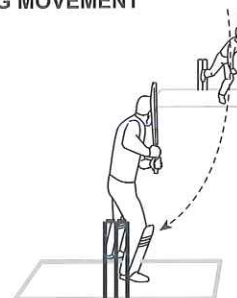
- Seam vertical but angled towards leg slip.
- Shiny side of the ball faces the off side.
- First two fingers close together on the seam.
- Flat of the thumb underneath the ball on the seam.

INSWING DELIVERY



- Bowled from slightly wider on the crease.
- Ball released with the bowling arm very high, the hand and fingers behind the ball.
- Head still, eyes level and focused on the target.
- Follow through with the bowling arm down the same side of the body.

INSWING MOVEMENT





● DRILLS: Pace Bowling - Outswing and Inswing Bowling

DRILL DESCRIPTION

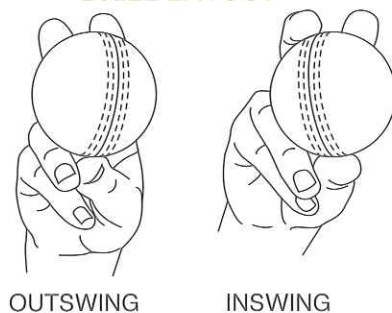
1 OUTSWING and/or INSWING

EQUIPMENT: 1 cricket ball per pair.

DRILL:

- Player A to pick up and grip the ball correctly.
- Player B to check to see the following are correct:
 - **OUTSWING GRIP** - the seam is upright and angled towards first slip, the shiny side faces the leg side, the first two fingers are close together on top of the seam, the thumb is on the seam underneath the ball.
 - **INSWING GRIP** - the seam is upright and angled towards leg slip, the shiny side faces the off side, the first two fingers are close together on top of the seam, the thumb is on the seam underneath the ball.
- Players then to change over and repeat the check.

DRILL LAYOUT

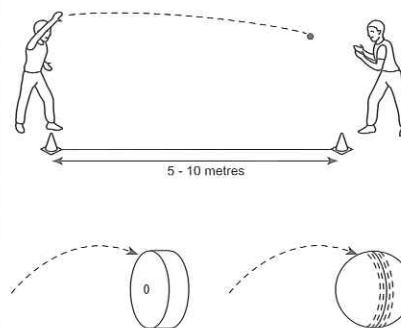


2 KEEPING THE SEAM UPRIGHT

EQUIPMENT: 2 cones, 1 bicoloured cricket ball [red and white], or 1 cricket ball with the seam painted white or taped, or 1 wooden disc [about 2cm thick and the same diameter as a cricket ball] per pair.

DRILLS:

- Set up two cones 5-10 metres apart with one player behind each cone.
- Player A to grip the ball or disc correctly and to throw it overarm to player B concentrating on keeping the seam upright.
- Player B to catch the ball or disc, to comment on the position and stability of the seam and give it a score from 1-5, then to repeat the drill. No score to be awarded if the ball wobbles through the air.
- Each player to have 12 throws.
- The player with the most points is the winner.
- Once the players have mastered this drill, get them to repeat it by bowling the ball to each other and monitoring the position of the seam.



3 SWINGING THE BALL

EQUIPMENT: 12 cones, 1 bicoloured cricket ball [red and white], or 1 cricket ball with the seam painted white or taped per pair.

DRILLS:

- Set up two cones 15-20 metres apart with one player behind each cone.
- Player A to measure his/her run-up, to hold the ball correctly with either an **OUTSWING GRIP** or an **INSWING GRIP**, to tell player B which way he /she intends to swing the ball, and then to run in and bowl either an outswing or an inswing delivery.
- Player B to stop the ball, to comment on the direction and degree of the swing, then to repeat the drill.
- **Variation:**
 - Create a straight line by placing a number of cones 1-2 metres apart between the two end cones. Players to attempt to swing the ball across the line.
 - Each player to bowl 12 deliveries [2 overs].
 - The player with the most correct deliveries which swing across the line is the winner.

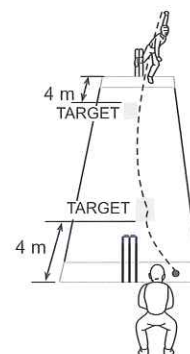


4 TARGET BOWLING

EQUIPMENT: 2 sets of stumps, 2 targets, 1 cricket ball per pair.

DRILLS:

- Set up the two sets of stumps 20 metres apart with one player behind each set.
- Place a target [e.g. a 50cm x 100cm rectangle of cardboard, carpet or plywood] on the pitch 4 metres in front of each set of stumps.
- Player A to measure his/her run-up, to grip the ball correctly, then to run in and bowl either an **OUTSWING** or an **INSWING** delivery so it swings, bounces on the target and hits the stumps.
- Player B to stop the ball and repeat the drill by bowling the ball back to player A.
- Each player to bowl 12 deliveries [2 overs] scoring 1 point for swinging the ball and bouncing it on the target and 2 points for hitting the stumps.
- The player with the most points is the winner.
- **Variation:**
 - Move the target to suit the line and length for a left hand batsman.





SKILL - Spin Bowling - Offspin and Legspin Bowling

Spin bowling is about taking wickets by spinning the ball hard. This achieves loop through the air and zip as the ball grips the pitch and turns sideways and bounces to different heights. Most teams have one or two spinners. Coaches are encouraged to use their spinners not just to tie up an end by bowling flat and tight, but to spin the ball hard and attack batsmen.

Spin bowlers need to be patient and work hard to develop their action and standard delivery so they can bowl with confidence and consistency of line, length and spin. As they progress spinners should be encouraged to experiment at practice so they can add variations in flight, pace and angle of attack to their repertoire to deceive and dismiss batsmen.

There are two main types of spinners - **FINGER SPINNERS** and **WRIST SPINNERS**.

FINGER SPINNERS

Finger spin bowlers are also known as 'orthodox' spinners because they use the first or index finger to spin the ball. Right arm finger spin bowlers are called 'off spinners' and left arm finger spin bowlers are called 'left-arm orthodox spinners'.

WRIST SPINNERS

Wrist spin bowlers use the wrist more than the fingers to spin the ball. Right arm wrist spin bowlers are called 'leg spinners' and left arm wrist spinners are referred to as 'chinaman bowlers'.

EXAMPLE: OFF SPIN BOWLING

Right arm off spinners use the first or index finger to impart spin on the ball so that it turns after it bounces from off to leg against right hand batsmen. They pitch the ball up just outside the off stump to try and bowl batsmen, or to cause them to misjudge the ball so they either hit it in the air and are caught, or leave their crease and be stumped.

EXAMPLE: LEG SPIN BOWLING

Right arm leg spinners use the wrist more than the fingers to impart spin on the ball so that it turns after it bounces from leg to off against right hand batsmen. They pitch the ball up on the line of the stumps to try and bowl batsmen, or cause them to edge a catch to the wicketkeeper or slips, or to leave their crease and be stumped.

OFF SPIN GRIP



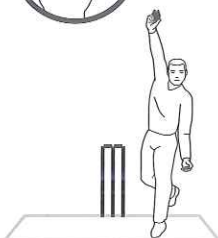
- Seam horizontal.
- Grip the ball firmly with the first two fingers spread as widely as possible across the seam.
- Rest the ball lightly on the thumb and third finger.

LEG SPIN GRIP



- Seam horizontal.
- Grip the ball firmly in the first two fingers spread widely across the seam and the third finger which is bent and along the seam.
- Rest the ball lightly on the thumb.

OFF SPIN DELIVERY



- Short, slightly angled delivery stride. Brace front leg. Pivot on the ball of the front foot.
- Bowling arm high with the wrist cocked inwards.
- Drive through with the back leg to rotate the body.
- Release the ball by turning the wrist vigorously clockwise [left to right] and ripping the first finger down the seam to impart spin. Finish with the back of the hand facing the leg side.
- Follow through strongly with the bowling arm across the body.

LEG SPIN DELIVERY



- Medium, slightly angled delivery stride. Brace front leg. Pivot on the ball of the front foot.
- Bowling arm high with the wrist cocked outwards.
- Drive through with the back leg to rotate the body.
- Release the ball by turning the wrist vigorously anticlockwise [right to left] and flicking the third finger hard over the seam to impart spin. Finish with the back of the hand facing the offside.
- Follow through strongly with the bowling arm across the body.

OFF SPIN MOVEMENT



LEG SPIN MOVEMENT





DRILLS: Spin Bowling - Offspin and Legspin Bowling

DRILL DESCRIPTION

1 THE GRIP - OFF SPIN and/or LEGSPIN

EQUIPMENT: 1 cricket ball per pair.

DRILL:

- Player A to pick up and grip the ball correctly.
- Player B to check to see the following are correct:
 - **OFF SPIN GRIP** - the ball is held firmly between the first two fingers which are spread widely across the seam and it rests lightly on the thumb and third finger.
 - **LEG SPIN GRIP** - the ball is held firmly in the first two fingers which are spread widely across the seam and the third finger which is bent and along the seam and it rests lightly on the thumb.
- Players then to change over and repeat the check.

2 SPINNING THE BALL 1

EQUIPMENT: 1 stump, 1 bicoloured cricket ball [red and white], or 1 cricket ball with the seam painted white or taped per pair.

DRILLS:

- Players in pairs to face each other in a kneeling position 5 metres apart.
- Each player to hold the ball correctly with either an **OFF SPIN** grip and to take turns to spin the ball clockwise to each other or a **LEG SPIN** grip and to take turns to spin the ball anticlockwise to each other.
 - Begin by **underarm spinning**. Watch carefully how the wrist and fingers twist to spin the ball. See who can spin the ball hardest.
 - Place a stump long ways between the players to act as a line. Take turns to spin the ball - either clockwise or anticlockwise - to try and get it to bounce on one side of the stump and then spin across it.
 - Next try **side or short-arm spinning** where the bowling hand is held at shoulder height with the elbow and wrist almost fully bent. The elbow remains bent as the forearm is brought over and the wrist rotates the ball. Again watch how the ball is released.
 - Finally try **overarm spinning**. Attempt to spin some with the eyes closed to feel how the wrist and fingers work to spin the ball.
- Once the players have mastered each of these drills kneeling, increase the distance between them and repeat the drills standing side-on.

3 SPINNING THE BALL 2

EQUIPMENT: 2 cones, 2 single stumps, chalk or tape, 1 cricket ball per pair.

DRILLS:

- Set up two cones 15-20 metres apart with one player beside each cone.
- Player A to stand side-on with the feet comfortably apart, to hold the ball correctly with either an **OFF SPIN** grip and to use only the shoulders and arms to bowl the ball to spin it clockwise or a **LEG SPIN** grip and to use only the shoulders and arms to bowl the ball to spin it anticlockwise.
- **NB:** The movement of the wrist and fingers is like reaching overhead and turning a door knob.
- Player B to stop the ball, then to adopt the above side-on position and bowl the ball back to player A.
- Each player to bowl 12 deliveries [2 overs].
- **Variations:**
 - Halfway between the two players:
 - **Option 1:** Use chalk to draw a target grid of five parallel lines 20 centimetres apart and 3 metres long. Players to try and land the ball in the target grid and score 1 point for each line of the grid that the ball crosses over on landing.
 - **Option 2:** Set up two stumps in a line 3 metres apart. Players to try and turn the ball through the gap between the stumps and score 1 point for each time they are successful.
 - Each player to have 12 attempts [2 overs].
 - The player with the most points is the winner.

4 TARGET BOWLING

EQUIPMENT: 2 sets of stumps, 2 targets, 1 cricket ball per pair.

DRILLS:

- Set up the two sets of stumps 20 metres apart with one player behind each set.
- Place a target [e.g. a 50cm x 100cm rectangle of cardboard, carpet or plywood] on the pitch 3 metres in front of each set of stumps - on or just outside the offstump for the off spinner and in line with the stumps for the leg spinner.
- Player A to measure his/her run-up, to grip the ball correctly, then to run in and bowl either an **OFF SPIN** or a **LEG SPIN** delivery so it bounces on the target, turns and hits the stumps.
- Player B to stop the ball and repeat the drill by bowling the ball back to player A.
- Each player to bowl 12 deliveries [2 overs] scoring 1 point for bouncing the ball on the target and 2 points for hitting the stumps.
- The player with the most points is the winner.
- **Variations:**
 - Move the target to suit the line and length for a left hand batsman.
 - Encourage players to flight or loop the ball by placing an obstacle [e.g. a chair or another set of stumps] in the middle of the pitch that the players need to bowl the ball over to land on the target.

DRILL LAYOUT

